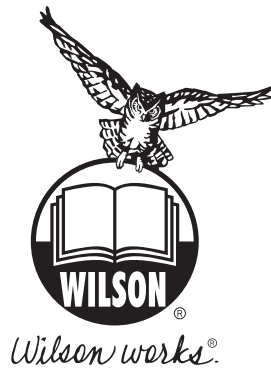


Wilson Reading System®

Student Reader Six



FOURTH EDITION

Wilson Language Training Corporation

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Kendra is Hopeful PART ONE

Kendra had only learned a few words by the end of first grade. She just could not crack the tricky code, and soon she felt helpless. Then, when she was older, she met Mrs. Cassidy who gladly told her, “I know how to instruct a wise student such as you.”

Kendra began working with Mrs. Cassidy every day after lunch. The lessons were sixty minutes each day, but the time did fly because Mrs. Cassidy was lively and made everything fun.

Every day in school, Kendra would get her white notebook off the shelf. It held all the notes and rules that she used during her lessons.

Kendra is Hopeful PART TWO

Kendra bravely learned how to decode the words and to be exact when she attempted to spell. Mrs. Cassidy presented the words in parts, first with sounds. Then, Kendra moved on to more difficult words. She had to divide these longer words into smaller chunks so she could get them right too.

Kendra took her time, focusing on the words and not rushing when she came across one she did not know. Kendra knew to tap it out and think about all the important skills she now owned.

Even when she had to write, it was not messy like it had been in the past. Plus, her spelling was developing quickly.

When Mrs. Cassidy asked, “Where is the blend in this word?” Kendra would boldly answer, “Right here!”

Things were falling into place, and Kendra was quickly becoming a top student. She now had a love for school and books.

It may take a few years to get completely through the whole program, but Kendra was sure this was a good investment. Thanks to Mrs. Cassidy, Kendra’s outlook was limitless!

A Safety Lesson

Brenna's school is hosting a safety talk today. The fifth grade class is extremely happy to find out that someone from the local firehouse is coming to talk to them about an important safety topic - smoke detectors. The kids love it when a visitor comes to their school.

The fifth grade welcomes firewoman, Nell Costa. Nell is set to begin her helpful talk just after lunch. Brenna is hopeful that she will learn something new about this useful subject.

Firewoman Nell begins by thanking the class for calling to invite her to give a talk. Quickly, she gets into a few facts. She tells the students that it is absolutely vital to install smoke detecting equipment the right way.

Smoke detectors must be put on every level of a home, even in the basement. Plus, they must be put in every bedroom in a house. They have to be dusted frequently and then tested often to make sure they still work. A working detector is the only kind that can help a family escape a fire.

Nell ends her talk by stressing one last fact. She tells the students that it could be a costly mistake if they don't conduct fire drills at home to plan their escape in case of a fire.

Brenna and the rest of the students are affected by the topic. They clap strongly for almost two minutes. Firewoman Costa has instructed them wisely about the role of smoke detectors in a safe home. She is a hero!

The Ladybug Problem PART ONE

Lilly and Jack own a beautiful log cabin in the hills. They don't get there much during the colder months, so each fall they love spending a few days at this spot before the first frost comes. The cabin has been constructed well, but on this first day of their visit, a big problem is at hand. When Lilly and Jack open the cabin, they find hundreds of ladybugs all over the walls!

They know they will have to react and fix this problem right away, but Lilly has a fondness for all insects and animals. So, they will have to find a way to remove these black and red bugs without killing them. Above all, Lilly says they must be mindful of the fact that ladybugs can bring good luck!

The Ladybug Problem PART TWO

Jack is glad he has brought his trusty laptop with him to the cabin. He goes online and finds a handy website to help him come up with an answer to this stressful problem.

Jack and Lilly must get the ladybugs to exit safely. They have an awareness that they must be careful as they are collecting all the ladybugs. These bugs can become upset if they are in distress. They will not bite anyone, but they will let off a not too lovely smell!

As Jack and Lilly collect the bugs a few at a time, they place them directly into a cloth bag and walk outside with the bagful of bugs to kindly let them go. Lilly is thankful as she sees the ladybugs safely fly away.

Cathy's Fateful Call

Cathy's family moved to beautiful Alabama early on in her life, and she had a love for fishing. One hot spring day along the Gulf of Mexico, Cathy had plans to go fishing with her brother, Lucas.

Suddenly, Cathy got a call. The man on the other end of the line had a job for her. Cathy almost hung up, because she thought it must be a joke. The man said he was calling to ask if Cathy would be open to singing at a local establishment next month. She had been recommended by a friend. Cathy secretly wanted to be a big-time singer, so she modestly responded, "Yes, I think so."

Cathy made plenty of time after school every day to prepare for the risky job singing publicly. She was a talented singer and good at the banjo too.

It would be thrilling with so many people witnessing her at the music event. This club was one of the best in the state of Alabama! An impressive accomplishment here, and a bit of luck, could develop into a limitless fate. Cathy had the ability to do quite well, and she was thankful that a friend gave her name above all others.

The evening of the big show came, and Cathy began her twenty-minute set of songs. The people attending the event were evidently crazy about her music. As she was set to finish her last song, they sprang up, clapping wildly. To her astonishment, she had won their hearts! Cathy gave a wave as she exited, and she knew she had found her true calling.

Work on the Docks

This is Jacob's second time working on the docks of a small cove off the Atlantic. The inlet is in the midst of immense rocks, and above it is a grassy cliff. The docks are home to several small ships and fishing boats. The tranquil water of the cove makes it a great home base for all kinds of vessels, big and small.

Jacob loves working in the golden sun and helping the shipowners dock their ships. The cove is often a busy site, so there are very few moments to relax. He attaches the docking lines when the ships come in. Then, if the ship is set to travel out to the Atlantic, he casts off the docking lines.

If there are strong winds, Jacob has to be extra attentive to ensure each vessel is safely in its place or on its way. Extremely strong onshore or offshore winds can bring about problems for the taller ships. They can rapidly pivot and shift without a minute to prepare. A crash into the docks can be a costly mistake. Jacob must not let such a mishap come to pass on his shift!

Jacob assists the shipowners with their equipment too, and he prides himself as a strong, dependable worker. Despite the fact that the job can be tricky and stressful, he is hopeful that he can come back to work again when school gets out.

An Eventful Day PART ONE

JoAnn and her husband, Chucky, had to prepare for the trip of their lifetime. They were going to beautiful Alaska in a few days! It would be a twenty-day trip, and there was a lot to do to prepare for such a long time away.

JoAnn and Chucky had a mile-long list of jobs to complete before they left. JoAnn was mindful of accomplishing most of the tasks on one eventful day off from work. She was good about neglecting all other tasks, and set out to complete her handy list. She was confident that she could use her quickness to get it all done. It was not a hopeless plan of attack!

JoAnn went to the bank first, and she was in and out in less than ten minutes! Next, she sprinted up the steps to the shop above the bank. She had to pick up some jackets, fuzzy socks, and bulky hats. On their trek across the vastness of Alaska they would be sure to find plenty of cold spots.

An Eventful Day PART TWO

At twelve o'clock JoAnn thought about a refreshment, but she felt it would be too disruptive to stop for lunch.

Before she could get off track, Chucky called. They met at the animal kennel to make sure their golden dog, Penny, would not be homeless while they were traveling. They could not help but love how much kindness the kennel owner exhibited toward the pets there. This made Chucky and JoAnn think they had found the right place for Penny.

They finally drove back to their house at five o'clock. To JoAnn's amazement, the listed tasks were complete. They were all set to go to Alaska!

A Filling for a Cavity PART ONE

Jake got off the bus at three o'clock. His mom was at the bus stop and she asked, "Jake, how was your American History test?"

Jake said, "Not very good. And lunch was bad too. I am sore every time I try to bite into food."

Jake's mom called the dentist as soon as they got back to the house. The dentist said that Jake most likely had a cavity and that it would need to be filled. They set up a time for Jake to go see the dentist the next day.

Jake brushed and flossed every day, but Mom told him that a cavity could still happen. Jake was upset, and he wished that he didn't have to go to the dentist. However, he knew he had to do it. He could not live with the soreness any longer.

Jake bravely went to visit the dentist the next day. She was a skilled dentist who had worked with Jake since he was four. Jake was thankful that the filling was not a difficult one. The dentist expected it to be a quick job.

A Filling for a Cavity PART TWO

Jake looked at the frame on the wall. It had the dentist's diploma from an American dental school. He kept trying to keep his mind off the shot he was about to get. The dentist told him to close his eyes and think about the ocean. She insisted that the shot would only feel like a quick pinch.

The dentist conducted her exam and checked each spot in Jake's mouth. The drill buzzed, and the dentist worked quickly. When she finished drilling and filling the cavity, she gave Jake a drink which he swished around and then spit into the sink. His lips felt funny, but it was not bad at all. Jake was positive that he had the best dentist on Earth!

The dentist told Jake not to munch on any food for a minimum of sixty minutes. So, Jake and his mom drove back home, and Jake relaxed on the sofa with his brand new smile.

A New Life on an Island PART ONE

The final day of school came at last. Maxwell and his sister, Trudy, were thinking about sun-filled days by the ocean. They had plans to relax and hang around with their friends for the next two months.

As they walked up the front steps to their house, Mom and Dad met them in the front hall. They instantly knew that something was up. Mom and Dad should have been at work.

Maxwell asked why they were at home so early. They answered, “We have very important news to share with you!”

Maxwell and Trudy learned that their mom had been presented with a new job. They would all be moving away from America soon. Mom's new job was on a tropical island. The kids were shocked by these statements. Trudy yelled, "What about school? What about our friends?"

Mom and Dad expected that their kids might not be thrilled with the news and might even get upset. So, they all sat down and discussed the plans for their big move.

A New Life on an Island PART TWO

Maxwell and Trudy listened intently to their mother and father. They learned about the work their mom would do, the school they would go to, and what life is like on the island of Aruba. Still, they protested until Mom and Dad said that they could think about it.

The move away from America had to be something the entire family wanted to do. The kids would have a say in it, and Mom could say yes or no to the job.

After their parents went to bed, Maxwell and Trudy got out of their beds and met at Maxwell's desk. They opened up his laptop and began to look up facts about this distant land called Aruba.

The siblings were focused on finding out everything they could about this tiny, flat island. They thought they could even find a good excuse to not move there!

However, website after website presented the white sandy shore, the Atlantic Ocean trade winds, and the crashing waves. It looked like pure bliss, and the kids began to understand why their parents wanted to move to this happy island.

Maxwell and Trudy talked until the sun came up. They had made up their minds, and they were set to tell their mother and father how they felt about the subject of the move.

Travel Map

Once a year, Tyrell and Jenna took time off from work and traveled all across America. They kept a big travel map on the wall in their den. After each trip, they checked the spot off on the map with a red pen. The last state to be checked off on the map was the most beautiful place on Earth - Alaska!

Tyrell and Jenna visited the Great Land with its astonishing Alaskan landscape and wildlife. They camped next to grand mountains and serene islands. They fished for halibut and took hikes across the frosty earth. They saw puffins, humpback whales, and massive chunks of ice in the ocean.

The best day of their trip was a risky six-mile rafting trip. The water rushed swiftly, and they got drenched. They ended their trip with a trek upland to pan for gold.

Now, when Tyrell and Jenna look at their map, they think, “Where shall we visit next?”

A Trip of a Lifetime

When the school year ended, Tony and Luca met to make their plans to travel to Italy. They both had relatives there and had been asked to come for an extended visit. They finished their travel plans, packed, and left for a long trip over the Atlantic Ocean.

The first stop on their trip was the arena in Rome. They were moved by the massive complex constructed of stone and concrete. Their next stop was a lively public square set within a maze of winding lanes. The square was filled with people, shops, and impressive monuments.

Tony and Luca then made their way to Tuscany. Tony was refreshed by the miles of beautiful wild blossoms and sunlit paths. Luca loved the taste of the pressed olives and wished he could live there more than anywhere on Earth.

Last, the young men drove west to where a volcano had erupted many years ago. They spent the rest of the month visiting with their families, and all too soon it was time to go back to America.

A Bike Ride on Nantucket

Betsy and Enzo loved to ride bikes and explore new places. Whenever they traveled, they rented some bikes and took off for the day. At first, they used the rented bikes for small rides, but they went on progressively longer and longer trips.

When Betsy and Enzo visited the island of Nantucket, they went right to the local bike rental shop. In fact, they were the first customers of the day. With bikes, a map, and helmets in hand, they set off for an eight-mile ride. They knew this was the best way to actively see the island.

Nantucket had miles and miles of bike paths away from the traffic. Betsy and Enzo were able to carefully follow the large map and stop along the way to take in the beautiful sites. They skillfully pedaled to the Nantucket Cliffs, Whale Rock, and the Old Windmill. They rested and had lunch on the shore of the Atlantic Ocean. Betsy and Enzo felt this was their best bike ride yet!

Crazy About Pumpkins PART ONE

David sat restlessly in class. When it was finally three o'clock, he followed the pack of students down the hallway and rushed to his locker to get his backpack. David had big plans for the rest of the day. His dad was picking him up and they were going to get some pumpkins! Thankfully, David's dad was on time, and they drove off to get the pumpkins.

David was crazy about pumpkins, and impressively, he knew all about these large orange fruits. He had been carefully collecting facts about pumpkins and knew that they could be found all over the world.

David would talk endlessly and pridefully about pumpkins. He knew that pumpkins had a lot of vitamin A and that they were mostly made of water. Sometimes, these pumpkin facts made people around him laugh, but to David, pumpkins were no joke!

Crazy About Pumpkins PART TWO

When David and his dad got to the farm, they got a wagon. David began selectively picking out the best pumpkins. In the end, he had carefully selected eight massively large pumpkins. His dad had to ask, “What are you going to do with all these pumpkins?”

David respectfully said, “I’m glad you asked. I can do so many things with these pumpkins! Let me list them for you.”

David then told his dad how many people often bake with pumpkins and that Native Americans used pumpkins to cure the sick. Lastly, David said that pumpkins were even good for your skin.

David's dad responded, "Well, I did not know of all that. I just thought you were going to put them all on the front steps!"

Following that statement, David was the one who had a good laugh.

The Life of a Chipmunk

What do we truly know about chipmunks? In America, we witness them scampering around all the time, but these tiny animals are up to some pretty big things.

There are twenty-five different kinds of chipmunks, and they live almost anywhere there are trees. They are small rodents with black and white stripes that run down their backs. Some chipmunks make their home by constructing a nest in a log or shrub. Others dig tirelessly in the earth to make twenty-foot tunnels. They dig down three feet from the opening and make pockets along the tunnel to store nuts.

Female chipmunks have two to eight baby chipmunks, called pups, at one time. The pups begin

life blind, pink, and with no hair. A mother chipmunk will protectively defend her pups.

Chipmunks are not very friendly with each other and, for the most part, they spend their time alone. They are mammals and are most active at sunrise and sunset, spending much of their time relentlessly and skillfully hunting for nuts. One chipmunk can collect over a hundred nuts in one day. Impressive! They endlessly stuff extra food in their cheeks. Not wanting to lose any, they bring the food back to their homes. What they don't consume, they stockpile, or store, for the colder months to follow.

It's not difficult to conclude that there is a lot to know about these small animals called chipmunks!

Tom Travels the Land PART ONE

Tom finished twelfth grade, and he had been a very good student. However, he did not want to extend his schooling quite yet. He wanted to follow his heart and endlessly travel across America. He was positive that he could find work along the way. His restlessness became so strong that he began to plan the trip. He collected all the vital belongings he must have with him for the eight-month trek.

First, he established himself in Atlanta and got a job at a bookstore. He relished talking with customers and relaxing in the public commons. However, the traffic in Atlanta was very bad. Therefore, Tom answered an ad about a job that sounded exactly like something he wanted to do.

Tom had nothing to lose, so he gratefully met with the old man who ran the ad. As a result, and most thankfully, Tom got the job to drive the man's van to Texas. Tom had never been to Texas, but was hopeful about the task at hand.

Tom Travels the Land PART TWO

The owner of the van wanted it to be in Texas within eight days. Thankfully, this gave Tom some time to stop and visit a new place or two. Tom was careful to follow his map and not lose his way.

First, he drove to Alabama, instinctively stopping at some of the important civil rights spots. He respectfully inspected documents at one institute, and reflected about this important American movement. Next, Tom visited the state capitol in Jackson, Mississippi. The large dome on top was quite impressive!

Tom fulfilled his task and got the old man's van to Texas in just five days. The man was impressed. The work had not been too difficult, but Tom was left to find a new job again. Tom wanted to progress farther west, so he began to carefully draft plans for the rest of his travel across America.

Apple Picking

Every fall Eva and her Uncle Mike went apple picking. They drove down a long and winding lane to get to the best apple picking spot in all of Wisconsin. Uncle Mike had no trouble finding a spot to put his truck, and the two walked to the gate to line up with all the other visitors.

Eva looked at the apple grove and saw a jungle of red and green. This year's crop was ripe and ready to be picked! Uncle Mike and Eva got their bags and set off into the middle of the maze of apples and trees. They hand-picked their apples one by one and filled their bags to the top.

In the end, Uncle Mike had a large bundle of Empire apples, and Eva had a bagful of Gala apples.

Uncle Mike intended to make apple cake with his apples, and Eva had plans to make a yummy apple crumble.

Although the apple picking had been fun, it had also made them hungry. They put the bags of apples in the truck and then visited the snack stand. Uncle Mike got a hot dog with a side of pickles. Eva selected a chicken sandwich with a double side of chips. Then, they snacked on samples of maple granola and homemade lemonade.

Uncle Mike and Eva made a quick stop at the stables to visit the cattle before walking back to the truck. As they drove off, they already suspected that this was their best apple picking day yet!

A Stumble in a Puddle

Janet was out for a jog when she had a bad stumble and twisted her ankle. She had fallen into a small puddle, and her legs were wet and full of mud. Although she was upset, Janet was able to limp over to the grass. She sat down to rest and wipe the mud and water off her legs.

All of a sudden, someone was calling out to Janet. It was her best friend, Dana, asking if she was okay. Janet limped over to her friend, and Dana helped her get into her vehicle. Dana insisted on bringing Janet home, so she could rest. During the drive, Janet told Dana exactly what had happened.

When she was home, Janet put her sore leg up on a table in the den. She put a cold pack on her ankle and kept her leg very still. Even though she was mad at herself for the careless tumble, Janet knew that she would be back to her old self in no time at all.

The next day, Janet was still limping, so she put tape around her ankle. Then, she called Dana to ask for a ride to school. Dana said that it was no trouble at all. Janet had to settle on the fact that it would be a while before her ankle would be ready for another jog.

Pete's Candle Shop

Pete opened his candle shop in June, and it was already a big hit. People traveled from all over to see the results of his talent and beautiful craft.

Pete had learned how to make his handmade candles from his grandmother. She had instructed him to first prepare the wax. Melting this silky stuff could be quite messy, but over time Pete had become very good at it. He used a double set of pans. The bottom pan was filled with water and the top pan was for the wax.

During the time that the wax was melting, Pete twisted strings to be used as wicks. When they were ready, he attached them to the bottom of metal cans and little glass bottles. The cans and bottles were all

different shapes and shades, but mostly he used red bottles in the shape of a rectangle.

After the wax was melted, Pete added the secret elements that made his candles smell so good. Then, he would drizzle the hot wax into the cans and bottles to make his very own brand of candles. The final product sometimes smelled like pineapples or vanilla. Other times, Pete made coconut or lime candles. There were hundreds of smells and it was impossible to name one as the best.

Pete had tables set up all over his shop to exhibit his lovely candles. Customers flocked to the shop to pick them up for their homes and to give away as gifts.

Jumping Rope

Jumping rope is not just something fun to do in your spare time. There are multiple fitness benefits as well. Swinging and jumping rope can promote strength in your legs and hands. It is good for your bones, and your heart will be stronger too!

To get ready to begin jumping rope, you must have good shoes and a strong rope with handles. A longer rope is best if you are just learning to jump rope. Although it will take more time for the rope to swing all the way around, a longer rope will result in less time spent unwinding tangles.

Music can help you focus on your jumps and skip without a struggle. You can even try to sing a little jingle, or whistle during your jumping workout.

It will take a long time to learn to jump fast and do difficult tricks such as a double under, a single leg hop, or a criss-cross. If it's been a while since you have swung a rope, don't be upset. It won't be too much trouble to get back into the swing of it! In fact, the basics are still the same. Standing up tall and doing small jumps is important. This will lessen the stress on your legs and ankles. Who knows - jumping rope may even make you think you are a little kid again!

James and the New Job

James was ready for his new job as a medical salesman. He had thought it would be good to take a gamble on a new job because his last one made him quite unhappy. His boss had been nothing but trouble, and the work had not been consistent. James had been constantly stressed about his bills.

James was instructed to be ready to attend an important meeting on the first day. There, he would mingle with the rest of the people in the large sales unit. He would then be handed all the folders with his customer files. James was hopeful he would not have to scramble to learn all the aspects of his new job at once. He wanted to be positive and focused on doing his best.

Although James would have restricted use of a laptop at first, he would get his own cubicle right away. During the day, he would make his calls selling medical products to clinics and hospitals all across America. James had always been able to handle himself well with customers. Even though James was a humble man, he was confident in his skills, and he began to think it was quite possible that this new job would be his last new job!

The Castle Visit PART ONE

James and Peg are traveling together from America to Scotland. It is difficult to handle the long plane ride and different time zone, so they go right to bed minutes after checking into their hotel.

They awake to the sunrise whistle and have to hustle to get the bus. They have booked tickets to go visit an old castle. The bus is ready at seven a.m. and sets off for the twenty-five mile trip to the castle. It does amuse Peg and James that all the vehicles drive on the left-hand side of the road, but it takes double the time to get to the address because of the rush hour traffic, and this is not so much fun.

During the ride, Peg and James use the extra time to study their little travel book and learn about the many mountains and islands of Scotland.

When the bus stops, Peg and James stumble out, still run-down from their eight-hour travel the day before. They walk on a pebble path with thistle plants on each side. “This prickly plant is the emblem of Scotland,” Peg says.

At the end of the path, a bagpipe band plays a Scottish melody for the visitors. The castle sits in front of a large hill, and cliffs to the west look down upon a vast ocean. Already, Peg and James are impressed with the dazzle of this beautiful place!

The Castle Visit PART TWO

Inside the castle, the old walls are damp and cold. Although the halls throughout the ample house are simple, they are elegant just the same. The noble families who dwelled here many years ago confronted much trouble, but commanded plenty of riches too.

Peg and James move from one end to the other, spending time in each part of the castle. During their ramble, they learn that the castle was built hundreds of years ago, though it had to be fixed after battles demolished it more than once.

Before they know it, it is time to assemble at the bus. James and Peg walk out into the drizzle and follow the path to the bus. This is a great first day, and James and Peg are ready to sample more!